

Task-Based User Evaluation Questions: *The Guide*

How the user evaluation should play out: Firstly, we need to run through each of the tasks, prompting the user before we even start to ***explain their thought process out loud***.

After going through each of the tasks, run through the game a second time and have the user expand on previous thoughts, things they would've considered logic to the gameplay and other parts that weren't as intuitive. ***(complete a pilot prior to our first evaluation)***

With the think aloud approach, if users encounter a problem we should 'ask them to describe the problem and rate it using a 4-point scale (cosmetic - catastrophic)':

1. Cosmetic Problem: This problem is making it slightly difficult to complete my task
2. Minor Problem: This problem is making it difficult to complete my task
3. Major Problem: This problem on the website is making it very difficult to complete my task
4. Catastrophic Problem: This problem on the website makes my task impossible to complete

We are also obliged to 'debrief' our users at the end of the eval, most of this is covered in consent form and information sheet, but obligatory "any questions" should be asked at the end.

Building & Placement Tasks

Scenario 1: Place an educational/accommodation/recreational/food building on map.

- **Think-aloud Prompt:**
 - i. *What were you thinking as you were placing the building, was anything particularly confusing?*
 - ii. *As you might have noticed, each building costs a certain amount of money, what are you considering while placing buildings (managing the budget)?*

Scenario 2: Try to place a building in the lake, or on top of another building.

- **Think-aloud Prompt:**
 - i. *How do these constraints affect your gameplay/strategy?*
 - ii. *What do you think of this visualization, are the restrictions clear?*

Scenario 3: Attempt to move/delete a building to improve your campus design.

- **Think-aloud Prompt:**
 - i. *What do you think will happen to your budget if you move/delete a building? (ASK BEFORE THE TASK)*
 - ii. *Would you consider this moving/deleting process easy?*
 - iii. *What do you think of the currency consequences, do you find the refund (half the building cost) for deleting the building fair?*

Scenario 4: Continue to build up the university campus until you run out of funds

- **Think-aloud Prompt:**
 - i. *Does the budget mechanic add to the fun or realism of the game?*
 - ii. *Do you feel the budget amount at the start of the game is adequate?*

Events & Satisfaction

1: Can you recognise and respond to events as they occur during the game?

- **Task:** React to the Duck Death event as it appears, and whether it requires action.
- **Think-aloud Prompt:**

- i. How do you decide what to do?*
- ii. What do you understand about this event, are the descriptions clear?*

2: Can you track the student's satisfaction level?

- **Task:** Monitor how the satisfaction level changes throughout the game (*after each events are reacted to ask the user to view the satisfaction level*)
- **Think-aloud Prompt:**
 - i. What do you think causes the satisfaction levels to rise and fall?*
 - ii. Do you feel like there is logic to achieving a high satisfaction score?*

3: Does the leaderboard display scores clearly and effectively?

- **Task:** View the leaderboard as the game concludes.
- **Think-aloud Prompt:**
 - i. What do you think about the leaderboard and how it reflects your performance?*

Feedback & Usability

1: Does the interface and layout on the screen (e.g., building options, events, satisfaction levels) seem clear and intuitive?

- **Think-aloud Prompt:**
 - i. What were your first thoughts about what each button or feature does? Explain what the icon & indicators mean as you see them.*

2: Did you find the game fun and engaging?

- **Think-aloud Prompt:**
 - i. Rate on a scale of 1-10, what made it less fun/engaging?*

3: Was increasing satisfaction and gaining achievements clear?

- **Think-aloud Prompt:**
 - i. What do you think about the achievements system? Does it encourage you to play differently?*

Bonus: What would you like to see implemented next?

Bonus: What do you think needs the most urgent work to improve the game?